

Linear Regression - Complete Notes

1. Introduction

Linear Regression is one of the most fundamental supervised machine learning algorithms. It is used to model the relationship between dependent and independent variables by fitting a linear equation to observed data.

2. Types of Linear Regression

Simple Linear Regression: Uses one independent variable.

Multiple Linear Regression: Uses multiple independent variables.

3. Equation of Linear Regression

Simple Linear Regression equation:

$$y = mx + c$$

Where:

y = dependent variable

x = independent variable

m = slope

c = intercept

4. Objective

The main objective is to find the best-fit line that minimizes prediction error.

5. Cost Function

The commonly used cost function is Mean Squared Error (MSE):

$$MSE = (1/n) * \sum (y_{\text{actual}} - y_{\text{predicted}})^2$$

6. Gradient Descent

Gradient Descent is an optimization algorithm used to minimize the cost function by updating parameters iteratively.

7. Assumptions of Linear Regression

- Linear relationship
- Independence of observations
- Homoscedasticity
- Normal distribution of residuals
- No multicollinearity

8. Evaluation Metrics

- Mean Absolute Error (MAE)
- Mean Squared Error (MSE)
- Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE)
- R^2 Score

9. Advantages

- Easy to implement
- Interpretable results
- Fast training

10. Disadvantages

- Sensitive to outliers
- Assumes linearity
- Poor performance on complex datasets

11. Applications

- House price prediction
- Stock market prediction
- Sales forecasting
- Risk assessment

12. Python Example

```
from sklearn.linear_model import LinearRegression
model = LinearRegression()
model.fit(X_train, y_train)
pred = model.predict(X_test)
```

Evaluation Metrics Table

Metric	Meaning
MAE	Average absolute error
MSE	Average squared error
RMSE	Square root of MSE
R ² Score	Goodness of fit